

PowerShell CommandNotFoundException

Fixing "The term 'tesseract' is not recognized" error in Windows PowerShell

Reported Terminal Error

```
PS C:\Users\Siva Ponakala> tesseract --version
tesseract : The term 'tesseract' is not recognized as the name of a cmdlet, function, script file, or
operable program. Check the spelling of the name, or if a path was included, verify that the path is
correct and try again.
At line:1 char:1
+ tesseract --version
+ ~~~~~
+ CategoryInfo          : ObjectNotFound: (tesseract:String) [], CommandNotFoundException
+ FullyQualifiedErrorId : CommandNotFoundException
```

Root Cause & Step-by-Step Resolution

This error occurs because **Tesseract OCR** is either not installed on your system or its binary directory has not been added to your Windows PATH environment variable. Follow the steps below to resolve it:

Step 1: Check if Tesseract is Already Installed

Open File Explorer and verify if the default installation folder exists:

```
C:\Program Files\Tesseract-OCR
```

- If `tesseract.exe` is present inside that directory, skip directly to **Step 3**.
- If the directory does not exist, proceed to **Step 2**.

Step 2: Download and Install Tesseract OCR

1. Download the Windows installer (e.g., from the UB-Mannheim Tesseract repository).
2. Run the installer and note the destination path (by default: `C:\Program Files\Tesseract-OCR`).
3. Complete the setup installation wizard.

Step 3: Add Tesseract to System PATH

1. Press **Win + R**, type `sysdm.cpl`, and press **Enter**.
2. Navigate to the **Advanced** tab and click **Environment Variables**.
3. Under **System variables** (or **User variables**), select **Path** and click **Edit**.
4. Click **New** and paste the directory path:

```
C:\Program Files\Tesseract-OCR
```

5. Click **OK** on all open dialog boxes to save changes.

Temporary session fix (current PowerShell session only):

```
$env:Path += ";C:\Program Files\Tesseract-OCR"
```

Step 4: Restart Terminal and Verify

Close your active PowerShell console completely, launch a new PowerShell window, and re-run:

```
tesseract --version
```

Python Integration (pytesseract) Tip

If you are using Tesseract in Python scripts, set the path programmatically:

```
pytesseract.pytesseract.tesseract_cmd = r'C:\Program Files\Tesseract-OCR\tesseract.exe'
```